

# NEXARION SOLUTIONS, INC.

## Employee Handbook & Policy Manual

Version 4.2 | Effective January 1, 2025  
Confidential - For Internal Use Only

|                   |                                                           |
|-------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| Headquarters      | 412 Meridian Parkway, Suite 800<br>Atlanta, Georgia 30308 |
| Founded           | 2009                                                      |
| Employees         | Approx. 1,400 (as of Q4 2024)                             |
| Industries Served | Technology, Financial Services, Healthcare IT             |
| HR Contact        | hr@nexarionsolutions.com   (404) 555-0192                 |
| Document Owner    | Chief People Officer, Human Resources Division            |

*This Employee Handbook supersedes all prior editions and applies to all full-time, part-time, and temporary employees of Nexarion Solutions, Inc. The policies contained herein are subject to change at the sole discretion of the Company. Nothing in this Handbook constitutes a contract of employment. Nexarion Solutions, Inc. is an at-will employer.*

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## Section 1: Welcome to Nexarion Solutions

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Welcome to Nexarion Solutions, Inc. We are delighted that you have chosen to join our team. Since our founding in 2009, Nexarion Solutions has grown from a boutique technology consultancy of twelve people into a dynamic organization of more than 1,400 professionals operating across six offices in the United States. Our work spans enterprise technology implementation, data analytics, cybersecurity, and digital transformation advisory services for clients in the financial services, healthcare IT, and commercial technology sectors.

This Employee Handbook is designed to provide you with a clear understanding of our expectations, policies, and the resources available to you throughout your career here. Please read it carefully, retain it for future reference, and direct any questions to your assigned HR Business Partner or the People Operations team at [hr@nexarionsolutions.com](mailto:hr@nexarionsolutions.com).

### 1.1 Our Mission, Vision & Values

**Mission:** To deliver intelligent, people-centered technology solutions that enable our clients to achieve transformative outcomes.

**Vision:** To be the most trusted strategic technology partner for growth-oriented organizations in North America.

**Core Values:**

- **Integrity First** - We act with honesty and transparency in everything we do.
- **Client Obsession** - We measure our success by our clients' success.
- **Continuous Learning** - We invest in growth - our own and our clients'.
- **Inclusive Excellence** - We believe diverse teams produce superior outcomes.
- **Accountable Innovation** - We take calculated risks and own our results.

### 1.2 A Message from the Chief People Officer

*"The talent and dedication of our people is Nexarion's single greatest competitive advantage. This Handbook reflects our commitment to building a workplace where you can do the best work of your career - one built on fairness, mutual respect, and shared purpose. We hold ourselves to high standards because our clients and our colleagues deserve nothing less. Thank you for being here." - Renata Holloway, Chief People Officer, Nexarion Solutions, Inc.*

## Section 2: Employment Policies & Classification

### 2.1 At-Will Employment

Employment at Nexarion Solutions, Inc. is at-will, meaning either the employee or the Company may terminate the employment relationship at any time, with or without cause, and with or without notice, subject to applicable federal, state, and local law. Nothing in this Handbook, in any offer letter, or in any communication from a Nexarion representative shall be construed to alter the at-will nature of employment unless expressly stated in a written agreement signed by the Chief Executive Officer and the Chief People Officer.

### 2.2 Equal Opportunity Employment

Nexarion Solutions, Inc. is an Equal Opportunity Employer. We are committed to providing equal employment opportunities to all applicants and employees without regard to race, color, religion, sex (including pregnancy, childbirth, and related medical conditions), national origin, age (40 or older), disability, genetic information, sexual orientation, gender identity or expression, marital status, veteran status, or any other characteristic protected by applicable federal, state, or local law.

This policy applies to all terms and conditions of employment, including recruiting, hiring, placement, promotion, termination, layoff, recall, transfer, leaves of absence, compensation, training, and benefits. Any employee found to have violated this policy is subject to disciplinary action up to and including termination.

### 2.3 Employee Classifications

Your employment classification determines your eligibility for benefits, overtime pay, and certain Company programs. Classification decisions are made by HR in consultation with your manager and are documented in your employment file.

| Classification  |           | Definition                                                               | Benefits Eligibility                 |
|-----------------|-----------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------|
| Full-Time (FTR) | Regular   | Works 32+ hours/week on an ongoing basis with no predetermined end date. | Full benefits package                |
| Part-Time (PTR) | Regular   | Works fewer than 32 hours/week on an ongoing basis.                      | Pro-rated PTO; limited benefits      |
| Full-Time (FTT) | Temporary | Works 32+ hours/week for a defined period not to exceed 12 months.       | No standard benefits; statutory only |
| Part-Time (PTT) | Temporary | Works fewer than 32 hours/week for a defined period.                     | No standard benefits                 |
| Intern / Co-op  |           | Student enrolled in an accredited academic program.                      | Stipend only; no benefits            |

|                        |                                                               |                       |
|------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------|
| Independent Contractor | Not an employee; engaged under a separate services agreement. | None (not applicable) |
|------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------|

*IMPORTANT: Misclassification of workers as independent contractors is a serious legal and financial risk. Managers must never engage an individual as a contractor without prior written approval from Finance and Legal. All contractor engagements must be documented using the Company's Master Services Agreement template.*

## 2.4 Immigration & Work Authorization

Nexarion Solutions complies with all federal immigration laws, including the Immigration Reform and Control Act of 1986 (IRCA). All newly hired employees must complete Form I-9 (Employment Eligibility Verification) within three (3) business days of their start date and must present acceptable documentation establishing identity and work authorization. The Company participates in the federal E-Verify program.

## Section 3: Onboarding & Orientation

### 3.1 Pre-Employment Requirements

All offers of employment are contingent upon the successful completion of the following pre-employment requirements. Failure to satisfy any requirement, or the discovery of material misrepresentation during this process, will result in withdrawal of the offer or immediate termination if already employed.

- **Background Check:** A comprehensive background screening will be conducted by Nexarion's third-party vendor (currently Sterling Talent Solutions). This includes criminal history (7-year lookback), employment verification (last 10 years or last 5 employers, whichever is greater), and education verification for all stated degrees.
- **Drug Screening:** A pre-employment 10-panel urinalysis drug screen is required for all Full-Time Regular and Full-Time Temporary employees. Employees in roles designated as Safety-Sensitive may also be subject to random testing.
- **Reference Checks:** HR will contact a minimum of two professional references provided by the candidate. Personal references (family members, friends) are not accepted.
- **Form I-9 Verification:** Must be completed in-person or via authorized remote notary within 3 business days of start date.
- **Signed Offer Letter & NDA:** The executed offer letter and Non-Disclosure / Non-Solicitation Agreement must be received by HR before system access is provisioned.

### 3.2 First-Day Procedures

On your first day, please report to the reception desk at your assigned office location at 9:00 AM unless otherwise directed by your manager or HR coordinator. Remote employees will receive a video conference link and must be online by 9:00 AM Eastern Time.

| Time                | Activity                                                                           | Led By              |
|---------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------|
| 9:00 - 9:30 AM      | Welcome, badge & access card issuance, building orientation                        | Facilities          |
| 9:30 - 10:30 AM     | HR check-in: paperwork, benefits enrollment window overview, policy acknowledgment | HR Business Partner |
| 10:30 AM - 12:00 PM | IT setup: laptop, VPN, email, system access, security training module              | IT Helpdesk         |
| 12:00 - 1:00 PM     | Welcome lunch with immediate team                                                  | Hiring Manager      |
| 1:00 - 3:00 PM      | Department overview, role expectations, 30-60-90 day plan review                   | Hiring Manager      |

|                |                                                                     |                     |
|----------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------|
| 3:00 - 4:30 PM | Compliance training modules (mandatory; must be completed by Day 5) | Self-paced (LMS)    |
| 4:30 - 5:00 PM | Q&A; / wrap-up with HR                                              | HR Business Partner |

### 3.3 New Employee Orientation Program (NEOP)

All Full-Time Regular employees participate in Nexarion's New Employee Orientation Program over their first 90 days. NEOP is delivered through a combination of instructor-led sessions, e-learning modules on our Learning Management System (Cornerstone OnDemand), and structured check-ins with HR.

| Phase                  | Timeframe  | Key Activities                                                                                            |
|------------------------|------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Phase 1:<br>Assimilate | Days 1-30  | Mandatory compliance training, systems access, meet key stakeholders, understand team charter             |
| Phase 2:<br>Accelerate | Days 31-60 | Shadow client engagements or project work, complete role-specific certifications, 30-day check-in with HR |
| Phase 3:<br>Contribute | Days 61-90 | Full project contribution, deliver 90-day self-assessment, receive formal feedback from manager           |

Mandatory compliance training modules that must be completed within the first five (5) business days include: Information Security Awareness, Anti-Harassment & Discrimination, Code of Conduct, Conflicts of Interest, and HIPAA Awareness (client-facing roles only). Failure to complete these modules will result in a hold on payroll processing.

*Note: Completion of mandatory training is tracked automatically in Cornerstone. If you experience technical difficulties accessing the LMS, contact the IT Helpdesk immediately at [helpdesk@nexarionsolutions.com](mailto:helpdesk@nexarionsolutions.com) or extension 5-HELP. Do not wait until the deadline to report issues.*

### 3.4 Probationary Period

All new Full-Time Regular employees are subject to a 90-day introductory probationary period. During this period, the employee and the Company assess mutual fit. Employees in their probationary period are not eligible to use accrued PTO (though accrual begins on Day 1), are not eligible for internal transfer or promotion, and may be separated with no requirement for a formal Performance Improvement Plan. At the manager's discretion and with HR approval, the probationary period may be extended by up to an additional 30 days one time. Extensions must be documented in writing and communicated to the employee no later than Day 85.

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## Section 4: Code of Conduct & Professional Standards

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### 4.1 General Expectations

Nexarion Solutions expects all employees to conduct themselves with the highest degree of professionalism, integrity, and respect - toward clients, colleagues, vendors, and the public. The following behaviors are expected at all times:

- Arrive prepared and on time for meetings, deadlines, and client engagements.
- Communicate respectfully and professionally in all written, verbal, and digital interactions.
- Maintain client and Company confidentiality in all settings, including social settings.
- Represent Nexarion Solutions positively in all public forums.
- Report known or suspected violations of Company policy promptly and in good faith.
- Dress appropriately for your role and work environment (see Section 4.1a).

**4.1a - Dress Code:** Nexarion maintains a business casual dress standard in all offices. Client-facing employees should adhere to the dress standard of the client site when on-site, defaulting to business professional if uncertain. Attire displaying offensive language, graphics, or content is strictly prohibited regardless of setting.

### 4.2 Conflict of Interest

Employees must avoid any situation in which their personal interests conflict, or appear to conflict, with the interests of Nexarion Solutions or its clients. A conflict of interest arises when an employee has a personal, financial, or other stake in a matter that could impair their objectivity or loyalty to the Company.

Examples of reportable conflicts include, but are not limited to:

- Holding a financial interest (greater than 1% equity) in a Nexarion competitor, client, or vendor.
- Serving as a director, officer, or advisor to a competitor, client, or vendor without disclosure.
- Hiring or supervising a family member or romantic partner.
- Receiving gifts, meals, or entertainment from a vendor or client exceeding the limits in Section 4.2a.
- Using Company resources, data, or relationships to benefit a personal business venture.

**4.2a - Gifts & Entertainment Policy:** Employees may accept unsolicited gifts of nominal value (not to exceed \$75 per occasion, \$150 aggregate per calendar year from any single source). Cash gifts and gift cards of any amount are never acceptable. All gifts received above \$50 must be disclosed to HR using the Gift Disclosure Form within five (5) business days.

### 4.3 Outside Employment

Employees may engage in outside employment provided it does not: (a) interfere with their Nexarion job responsibilities, (b) create a conflict of interest, (c) involve the use of Company resources, or (d) involve employment with a competitor, active client, or active vendor. Employees must disclose all outside employment to HR in writing prior to commencing such work. Nexarion reserves the right to require discontinuation of outside employment that is determined to be in conflict with Company interests.

## 4.4 Social Media Policy

Employees may maintain personal social media accounts and are not required to promote Nexarion content. However, employees must not:

- Post, share, or discuss confidential client information, project details, or proprietary Company data on any platform.
- Represent their personal opinions as official Nexarion positions.
- Make disparaging, defamatory, or harassing statements about Nexarion, clients, colleagues, or competitors.
- Use the Nexarion logo, wordmark, or trademark without written approval from Marketing.
- Engage in political advocacy in a manner that could be attributed to or embarrass the Company.

*Employees who maintain LinkedIn profiles are encouraged (but not required) to list their accurate current role at Nexarion. Any statements about the Company's work, size, or performance must be consistent with publicly available information.*

## Section 5: Work Hours, Attendance & Remote Work

### 5.1 Standard Business Hours

Nexarion's standard business hours are Monday through Friday, 8:00 AM to 6:00 PM local time at each office. Core collaboration hours - during which all employees in a given time zone should be available - are 10:00 AM to 3:00 PM local time. Flexible start/end times may be arranged with manager approval, provided core hours are covered and client commitments are met.

### 5.2 Attendance & Punctuality

Regular, reliable attendance is an essential function of every position at Nexarion Solutions. Employees who will be absent or late must notify their manager and, where applicable, project team lead, as early as possible and no later than 30 minutes after their expected start time. Notifications should be made via direct phone call or instant message (Teams); email alone is not sufficient for same-day absences.

| Occurrence Type   | Definition                                                                  | Trigger for Review                     |
|-------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------|
| Unexcused Absence | Absence with no prior approval and no acceptable justification.             | 2nd occurrence in 60-day period        |
| Excused Absence   | Absence approved in advance or with same-day notification and valid reason. | 7th occurrence in rolling 12 months    |
| Tardiness         | Arrival more than 10 minutes after scheduled start.                         | 3rd occurrence in 30-day period        |
| No Call / No Show | Absence with no notification to manager.                                    | 1st occurrence triggers formal warning |
| Abandonment       | 3 or more consecutive no call / no shows.                                   | Presumed voluntary resignation         |

### 5.3 Remote & Hybrid Work Policy

Nexarion Solutions supports flexible work arrangements that maintain client service quality, team cohesion, and operational effectiveness. Remote and hybrid arrangements are a privilege, not a right, and are subject to role requirements, performance standing, and manager/leadership approval.

#### Eligibility Requirements for Remote/Hybrid Status:

- Must have completed the 90-day probationary period (new hires are on-site by default).
- Must be in good standing (no active PIPs, formal warnings, or disciplinary actions).
- Role must be classified as Remote-Eligible by the department head in consultation with HR.
- Must maintain a suitable, private, distraction-minimized home workspace meeting Nexarion's ergonomic and security standards.

- Must be reachable during core hours via phone, Teams, and email with response times equivalent to on-site standards.

**Remote Work Equipment & Expense:**

Nexarion will provide a standard-issue laptop, VPN client, and required software for remote employees. A one-time home office setup stipend of \$400 is available upon request, subject to receipts submitted within 90 days of the arrangement start date. Employees are responsible for maintaining a reliable internet connection (minimum 50 Mbps download / 10 Mbps upload). Nexarion does not reimburse ongoing internet costs unless the employee is in a role formally designated as Fully Remote Exempt, which requires VP-level approval.

*Remote work arrangements may be revoked at any time for business reasons, performance concerns, or policy violations with as little as 5 business days' notice. Repeated failure to be available during core hours constitutes an attendance violation and will be addressed under Section 10 (Disciplinary Procedures).*

## 5.4 Travel & Expense Policy

Employees required to travel for client engagements or internal business purposes must book travel through Nexarion's designated travel management platform (Concur) using the Company's preferred vendors. All travel above \$1,500 per trip requires manager approval prior to booking. Business-class air travel is only permitted for international flights exceeding 7 hours of flight time, with VP or above authorization.

Meal per diem rates follow the current U.S. GSA schedule. Alcohol is not reimbursable as a standalone expense; it may be included in a client entertainment expense with manager approval and must be clearly itemized on the receipt. All expenses must be submitted within 30 days of incurrence or will not be reimbursed.

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## Section 6: Compensation & Pay Practices

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### 6.1 Pay Schedule

Nexarion Solutions pays all employees on a bi-weekly basis (26 pay periods per year). Pay dates fall every other Friday. When a scheduled pay date falls on a federal holiday, payroll will be processed on the preceding Thursday. The Company uses ADP Workforce Now as its payroll system. Employees can access their pay stubs, W-2s, and tax withholding information via the ADP employee self-service portal at any time.

Direct deposit is the default and strongly encouraged method of payment. Paper checks are available upon written request but will be distributed one business day after the standard pay date. Nexarion does not offer payroll advances or loans.

### 6.2 Overtime

Nexarion Solutions complies with the Fair Labor Standards Act (FLSA) and applicable state wage and hour laws. Non-exempt employees who work more than 40 hours in a designated workweek (Monday 12:00 AM through Sunday 11:59 PM) will receive overtime compensation at 1.5x their regular hourly rate.

*IMPORTANT: All overtime must be pre-approved by the employee's manager. Working unauthorized overtime is a policy violation and may result in disciplinary action, though the Company will still compensate all hours worked regardless of authorization status, as required by law. Exempt employees are not eligible for overtime compensation.*

### 6.3 Pay Adjustments & Merit Increases

Pay adjustments at Nexarion Solutions may occur through several mechanisms:

- **Annual Merit Review:** Conducted each January coinciding with the prior-year performance cycle. Merit increases are based on individual performance rating, role benchmarking against market data (Radford Global Technology Survey), and budget availability. The Company does not guarantee annual increases.
- **Promotion Increases:** Employees promoted to a higher job band receive a minimum increase of 8% or an adjustment to the new band's minimum, whichever is greater.
- **Equity Adjustments:** HR conducts a pay equity analysis annually and may make corrections to address identified disparities, independent of performance.
- **Retention Agreements:** Key employees may be offered retention bonuses subject to a 12- or 24-month repayment clawback if the employee voluntarily resigns within the retention period.

## Section 7: Employee Benefits

Nexarion Solutions is committed to providing a competitive benefits package that supports your health, financial security, and overall well-being. Benefits are available to Full-Time Regular employees and their eligible dependents. The details in this section represent a summary only; the official Plan Documents govern all determinations. Copies are available on the HR portal.

### 7.1 Health, Dental & Vision Insurance

Nexarion offers three health plan tiers through Anthem Blue Cross Blue Shield. Enrollment or changes are only permitted during the annual Open Enrollment window (typically November 1-15) or within 30 days of a Qualifying Life Event (QLE). Failure to enroll within the QLE window will result in the employee remaining on their prior plan or being ineligible until the next Open Enrollment.

| Plan Tier      |         | Employee Premium/Month | Employer Contribution | Deductible (In-Network) | OOP Max (In-Network) |
|----------------|---------|------------------------|-----------------------|-------------------------|----------------------|
| NexCare (HDHP) | Basic   | \$48.00                | 92%                   | \$1,500 / \$3,000       | \$4,000 / \$8,000    |
| NexCare (PPO)  | Plus    | \$184.00               | 82%                   | \$500 / \$1,000         | \$2,500 / \$5,000    |
| NexCare (PPO+) | Premier | \$312.00               | 76%                   | \$250 / \$500           | \$1,500 / \$3,000    |

**Health Savings Account (HSA):** Employees enrolled in the NexCare Basic HDHP are eligible for an HSA through HealthEquity. Nexarion contributes \$600/year for individual coverage and \$1,200/year for family coverage in two equal installments (January 1 and July 1). Employee contributions are pre-tax up to IRS annual limits. HSA funds roll over indefinitely and are portable upon separation.

**FSA:** Employees enrolled in NexCare Plus or Premier plans may enroll in a Healthcare Flexible Spending Account. FSA funds are use-it-or-lose-it with a \$610 rollover allowance per IRS rules. A Dependent Care FSA (up to \$5,000/year) is available to all FTR employees regardless of health plan enrollment.

**Dental:** Nexarion offers dental coverage through MetLife. The Company covers 100% of preventive services. Basic restorative services (fillings, extractions) are covered at 80% after a \$50 deductible. Major services (crowns, bridges, implants) are covered at 50% after the deductible. Annual benefit maximum is \$2,000 per covered person. **Vision:** VSP Vision Care covers one comprehensive eye exam per year and \$200 allowance toward frames/lenses or contact lenses annually.

### 7.2 401(k) Retirement Plan

Nexarion Solutions sponsors a 401(k) plan through Fidelity Investments. Employees are eligible to contribute beginning on the first day of employment. The Company provides a matching contribution under the following tiered schedule:

| Employee Contribution   | Nexarion Match                 | Notes                                        |
|-------------------------|--------------------------------|----------------------------------------------|
| 1% - 3% of compensation | 100% match (dollar for dollar) | Match begins Day 1 of employment             |
| 4% - 6% of compensation | 50% match                      | Applied on top of the first-tier match       |
| Above 6%                | No additional match            | Employee contributions still pre-tax or Roth |

**Vesting Schedule:** Employer match contributions vest according to the following graduated schedule:

| Years of Service | Vested Percentage |
|------------------|-------------------|
| Less than 1 year | 0%                |
| 1 year           | 25%               |
| 2 years          | 50%               |
| 3 years          | 75%               |
| 4+ years         | 100%              |

*Employee contributions are always 100% immediately vested. Only the employer match follows the vesting schedule. Years of service are calculated from your original hire date. If you leave and are rehired within 12 months, prior service may be credited; consult HR for details.*

### 7.3 Life & Disability Insurance

Nexarion provides the following group insurance coverages at no cost to Full-Time Regular employees:

- **Basic Life Insurance:** 2x annual base salary, up to a maximum of \$500,000. Coverage is effective on your first day of employment.
- **AD&D; (Accidental Death & Dismemberment):** Equal to your Basic Life benefit. Paid to your designated beneficiary or as a schedule of benefits for qualifying injuries.
- **Short-Term Disability (STD):** 60% of base salary, up to \$2,500/week, for up to 12 weeks following a 7-day elimination period.
- **Long-Term Disability (LTD):** 60% of base salary, up to \$10,000/month, beginning after 90 days of continuous disability, until age 65 or recovery.

Employees may purchase supplemental life insurance in increments of \$10,000 up to 5x salary (\$500,000 maximum for employee; \$250,000 for spouse/domestic partner; \$10,000 / \$20,000 for children). Evidence of Insurability (EOI) is required for amounts above guaranteed issue limits.

### 7.4 Paid Time Off (PTO)

Nexarion Solutions uses a unified PTO model. There are no separate buckets for vacation, sick time, or personal days - all are drawn from a single PTO balance. PTO accrues bi-weekly beginning on Day 1 of employment, but may not be taken until completion of the 90-day probationary period (except for state-mandated sick leave purposes,

which may be used starting Day 1).

| Years of Service | Annual PTO Accrual | Bi-Weekly Accrual Rate | Maximum Carryover |
|------------------|--------------------|------------------------|-------------------|
| 0 - 2 years      | 15 days (120 hrs)  | 4.62 hrs/period        | 22 days (176 hrs) |
| 3 - 5 years      | 18 days (144 hrs)  | 5.54 hrs/period        | 26 days (208 hrs) |
| 6 - 9 years      | 22 days (176 hrs)  | 6.77 hrs/period        | 30 days (240 hrs) |
| 10+ years        | 25 days (200 hrs)  | 7.69 hrs/period        | 35 days (280 hrs) |

**Carryover & Payout:** Unused PTO above the carryover cap is forfeited on January 1 each year. PTO is not paid out upon resignation or termination in states where such payout is not legally required. In California and states with similar statutes, all accrued, unused PTO will be paid out at the employee's final rate of pay. Employees may not take PTO in advance of accrual without written manager and HR approval (negative PTO balances exceeding 24 hours require VP authorization).

## 7.5 Holidays

Nexarion Solutions observes the following paid holidays. If a holiday falls on a weekend, the observed date will be the preceding Friday (Saturday holidays) or the following Monday (Sunday holidays).

| Holiday                                     | Observed Date (2025)   |
|---------------------------------------------|------------------------|
| New Year's Day                              | Wednesday, January 1   |
| Martin Luther King, Jr. Day                 | Monday, January 20     |
| Presidents' Day                             | Monday, February 17    |
| Memorial Day                                | Monday, May 26         |
| Juneteenth National Independence Day        | Thursday, June 19      |
| Independence Day                            | Friday, July 4         |
| Labor Day                                   | Monday, September 1    |
| Thanksgiving Day                            | Thursday, November 27  |
| Day After Thanksgiving                      | Friday, November 28    |
| Christmas Eve (half day - closes 12:00 PM)  | Wednesday, December 24 |
| Christmas Day                               | Thursday, December 25  |
| New Year's Eve (half day - closes 12:00 PM) | Wednesday, December 31 |

Additionally, each employee receives two (2) Floating Holidays per calendar year, which may be used for any reason with manager approval. Floating Holidays do not roll over and have no cash value.

## 7.6 Employee Assistance Program (EAP)

Nexarion partners with Lyra Health to provide a comprehensive EAP at no cost to employees and their household members. EAP services include:

- Up to 16 counseling sessions per issue, per year with a licensed therapist (in-person or video).
- Financial counseling and debt management guidance.
- Legal consultation (30-minute initial session at no charge).
- Caregiver support and elder care referrals.
- 24/7 crisis support line: 1-800-NEX-HELP (1-800-639-4357).

## 7.7 Wellness Stipend & Professional Development

**Annual Wellness Stipend:** FTR employees receive a \$600 annual wellness stipend, reimbursable against eligible expenses including gym memberships, fitness equipment, mental health apps, meditation subscriptions, and nutrition coaching. Claims must be submitted through ADP Expense by November 30 of each year. Unused stipend does not roll over.

**Professional Development Fund:** FTR employees are eligible for up to \$2,500 per fiscal year for job-relevant professional development, including certification exams, training courses, conference attendance, and approved books/materials. All development spend requires manager pre-approval via the PD Request Form in Workday. Employees who voluntarily resign within 12 months of receiving development funding exceeding \$1,000 are subject to a prorated repayment obligation.

## Section 8: Leave of Absence Policies

### 8.1 Family & Medical Leave (FMLA)

Nexarion Solutions complies fully with the federal Family and Medical Leave Act of 1993 (FMLA) and applicable state equivalents. Eligible employees may take up to 12 weeks of unpaid, job-protected leave per 12-month period (measured on a rolling backward basis) for qualifying reasons.

**FMLA Eligibility:** Employee must have worked for Nexarion for at least 12 months and at least 1,250 hours in the prior 12-month period at a location with 50+ employees within 75 miles.

**Qualifying Reasons:**

- Serious health condition of the employee.
- Care for a spouse, child, or parent with a serious health condition.
- Birth, adoption, or foster placement of a child (within 12 months of the event).
- Qualifying military exigencies (up to 26 weeks for care of a covered servicemember).

Employees must provide 30 days' advance notice when the need for leave is foreseeable. FMLA runs concurrently with any paid leave (PTO, STD) that applies. Nexarion will continue group health insurance during FMLA leave under the same terms as if the employee had continued to work.

### 8.2 Parental Leave

In addition to FMLA entitlements, Nexarion provides paid Parental Leave for qualifying events (birth, adoption, surrogacy, or foster placement):

| Employee Type                             | Leave Entitlement | Pay Status                     |
|-------------------------------------------|-------------------|--------------------------------|
| Primary Caregiver (FTR, 1+ year tenure)   | 12 weeks          | 100% base pay                  |
| Secondary Caregiver (FTR, 1+ year tenure) | 4 weeks           | 100% base pay                  |
| Primary Caregiver (FTR, under 1 year)     | 6 weeks           | 60% base pay (STD coordinates) |
| Secondary Caregiver (FTR, under 1 year)   | 2 weeks           | 100% base pay                  |

### 8.3 Bereavement Leave

Nexarion provides paid bereavement leave for the death of an immediate or extended family member. Leave is separate from PTO and does not reduce the employee's balance.

| Relationship                                                    | Paid Leave Provided |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------|
| Spouse / Domestic Partner, Child (including stepchild, adopted) | 5 business days     |
| Parent, Sibling, Grandparent, Grandchild, Parent-in-Law         | 3 business days     |
| Aunt/Uncle, Niece/Nephew, First Cousin, Sibling-in-Law          | 1 business day      |
| Close friend or non-family member (with manager discretion)     | 1 business day      |

*Employees may request up to 5 additional days of unpaid leave (or use PTO) following bereavement if additional time is needed. Manager approval is required. Nexarion recognizes that grief is not linear and encourages employees to contact the EAP for grief counseling support.*

## 8.4 Military Leave

Nexarion supports its employees who serve in the U.S. Armed Forces (including the National Guard and Reserves) and complies with the Uniformed Services Employment and Reemployment Rights Act (USERRA). Employees on military leave of up to 30 days will receive the difference between their military pay and their regular Nexarion base pay. For leaves exceeding 30 days, the employee moves to unpaid status but retains health insurance continuation rights and reemployment protections under USERRA for up to 5 years.

## 8.5 Jury Duty & Civic Leave

Employees summoned for jury duty will receive their full base pay for up to 15 business days of service per calendar year. The employee must provide a copy of the jury summons to HR within 3 business days of receipt. If jury service extends beyond 15 days, the employee may use PTO for additional days. Employees are expected to return to work on days when they are released from jury service before 2:00 PM. Civic volunteer activities (voting, serving as an election official) are encouraged; up to 3 hours of paid civic leave are available per applicable election.

## Section 9: Performance Management

### 9.1 Annual Review Cycle

Nexarion Solutions uses a continuous performance management approach complemented by a formal annual review cycle. All FTR employees participate in the following structured touchpoints:

| Touchpoint                        | Frequency            | Participants                       | System           |
|-----------------------------------|----------------------|------------------------------------|------------------|
| 1-on-1 Check-ins                  | Weekly (recommended) | Employee + Manager                 | Teams / Calendar |
| Quarterly Goals Review            | 4x per year          | Employee + Manager                 | Workday          |
| Mid-Year Development Conversation | June/July            | Employee + Manager + HR (optional) | Workday          |
| Annual Performance Review         | January (prior year) | Employee + Manager + HR            | Workday          |
| 360-Degree Peer Feedback          | Annual (Oct/Nov)     | Employee + peers + direct reports  | Workday          |

Performance ratings are assigned on a 5-point scale: (1) Does Not Meet Expectations, (2) Partially Meets Expectations, (3) Meets Expectations, (4) Exceeds Expectations, (5) Outstanding. Ratings distribution is subject to calibration. Managers may not rate more than 15% of their team at level 5 or more than 10% at level 1 without documented justification approved by their VP and HR.

### 9.2 Performance Improvement Plans (PIPs)

A Performance Improvement Plan (PIP) is a formal tool used when an employee's performance is consistently below expectations and other informal coaching has not produced adequate improvement. A PIP is not a disciplinary action per se, but it is a serious document indicating that continued employment depends on measurable improvement.

#### PIP Process:

- **Initiation:** Manager drafts the PIP in consultation with HR. The PIP must include specific, measurable performance deficiencies; clear improvement targets; a support plan; a timeline (typically 30-90 days); and consequences for failure to improve.
- **Meeting:** The PIP is presented to the employee in a private meeting with the manager and an HR representative. The employee receives a copy and is asked to sign acknowledging receipt (signature does not constitute agreement).
- **Monitoring:** Formal check-ins occur at minimum every two weeks during the PIP period. Progress is documented in Workday.
- **Conclusion:** At the end of the PIP period, the manager and HR determine: (a) PIP objectives met - employee returns to standard performance management; (b) partial progress - PIP extended up to 30 additional days (one

time only); (c) objectives not met - employment may be terminated.

## Section 10: Disciplinary Procedures

Nexarion Solutions believes in progressive discipline as a constructive mechanism for addressing performance and conduct issues. The Company reserves the right, however, to skip any step in the process - up to and including immediate termination - based on the severity of the conduct, the employee's history, and the circumstances of the situation.

| Step   | Action                             | Documentation Required                                                   | Typical Triggers                                          |
|--------|------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| Step 1 | Verbal Warning / Coaching          | Manager notes in Workday                                                 | 1st minor policy violation; attendance pattern beginning  |
| Step 2 | Written Warning                    | Signed written document in employee file                                 | Repeated minor violations; first moderate violation       |
| Step 3 | Final Written Warning / Suspension | Signed document; HR must co-sign; may include unpaid suspension 1-3 days | Serious policy violation; failure to improve after Step 2 |
| Step 4 | Termination                        | Termination letter; HR and legal review                                  | Continued failure to improve; serious misconduct          |

### Acts Subject to Immediate Termination (Zero-Tolerance):

The following conduct may result in immediate termination without prior disciplinary steps, regardless of the employee's tenure or performance history:

- Workplace violence, threats of violence, or physical assault.
- Theft, fraud, embezzlement, or willful destruction of Company or client property.
- Sexual misconduct or assault.
- Falsification of employment application, time records, expense reports, or other Company documents.
- Possession, distribution, or use of illegal substances on Company premises or while performing Company business.
- Unauthorized disclosure of confidential client data or trade secrets.
- Violation of computer security policies resulting in a confirmed or suspected data breach.
- Gross insubordination (willful refusal to follow lawful directives of management).

*Employees have the right to provide their perspective at each stage of the disciplinary process. Retaliation against any employee for good-faith participation in a disciplinary or investigative proceeding is strictly prohibited and is itself a terminable offense.*

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## Section 11: Harassment, Discrimination & Retaliation

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Nexarion Solutions maintains an absolute commitment to a work environment free from all forms of harassment, discrimination, and retaliation. This policy applies to all employees, contractors, clients, and visitors in any work-related setting - including remote workspaces, client sites, offsite events, and digital communications.

### 11.1 Prohibited Conduct

**Harassment** includes unwelcome conduct based on a protected characteristic that is severe or pervasive enough to create a hostile, intimidating, or offensive work environment, or that results in an adverse employment action. This includes:

- Verbal harassment: slurs, epithets, jokes, derogatory comments based on any protected class.
- Physical harassment: unwanted touching, invasion of personal space, physical intimidation.
- Visual harassment: displaying offensive images, gestures, or written materials.
- Sexual harassment: unwelcome sexual advances, requests for sexual favors, and other verbal or physical conduct of a sexual nature (both quid pro quo and hostile work environment).
- Cyberbullying and digital harassment via email, Teams, social media, or any other platform.

### 11.2 Reporting Procedure

Any employee who believes they have experienced or witnessed harassment, discrimination, or retaliation should report it promptly using any of the following channels:

- **Direct HR Report:** Contact your HR Business Partner or the HR Director directly at [hr@nexarionsolutions.com](mailto:hr@nexarionsolutions.com).
- **Ethics Hotline:** Anonymous reports may be submitted 24/7 via Nexarion's third-party Ethics Hotline at 1-888-NEX-ETHX (1-888-639-3849) or online at [nexarion.ethicspoint.com](https://nexarion.ethicspoint.com).
- **Legal/Compliance:** Employees may also report directly to the General Counsel at [legal@nexarionsolutions.com](mailto:legal@nexarionsolutions.com).

All reports will be investigated promptly, thoroughly, and impartially by HR or an independent investigator. The confidentiality of all parties will be maintained to the extent practicable. Retaliation against any person who makes a good-faith complaint or participates in an investigation is strictly prohibited and will result in disciplinary action up to and including termination.

## Section 12: Technology, Data & Confidentiality

### 12.1 Acceptable Use of Technology

All hardware, software, network access, and communication systems provided by Nexarion are Company property and are provided for business use. Limited, reasonable personal use is permitted provided it does not: interfere with work duties, consume excessive bandwidth, violate this policy, or create legal liability for the Company.

#### Prohibited Uses Include:

- Accessing, transmitting, or storing illegal content of any kind.
- Installing unauthorized software or applications on Company devices.
- Circumventing security controls, VPN requirements, or endpoint protection.
- Mining cryptocurrency or running non-business compute-intensive processes.
- Accessing personal cloud storage (Dropbox, personal Google Drive, etc.) to store Company or client data.
- Using AI generative tools (ChatGPT, Gemini, etc.) to input confidential client data, proprietary source code, or non-public Company information without IT-approved tools.

*Employees have no expectation of privacy when using Company systems. Nexarion reserves the right to monitor, access, and review all activity on Company-owned devices and networks at any time, with or without notice, to the fullest extent permitted by law.*

### 12.2 Data Classification & Handling

| Classification    | Examples                                             | Handling Requirements                                                              |
|-------------------|------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Confidential      | Client PII, financial data, M&A; info, trade secrets | Encrypted at rest & in transit; need-to-know only; no external sharing without NDA |
| Internal Use Only | Internal memos, project plans, HR data               | Not for external distribution; accessible to employees on need-to-know basis       |
| Public            | Marketing materials, approved press releases         | May be shared externally; no restrictions                                          |

### 12.3 Confidentiality & Non-Disclosure

As a condition of employment, all employees execute a Confidentiality, Non-Disclosure, and Non-Solicitation Agreement. The confidentiality obligations survive the termination of employment indefinitely with respect to trade secrets and for a period of two (2) years with respect to other confidential information. The non-solicitation obligations (clients and employees) survive for twelve (12) months post-separation.

Upon separation, employees must promptly return all Company property and delete all Company or client data from personal devices. IT will conduct an offboarding review of the employee's accounts within 24 hours of separation.

notice.

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## Section 13: Separation of Employment

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### 13.1 Voluntary Resignation

Employees wishing to resign are requested to provide advance written notice to their manager and HR. While Nexarion appreciates notice as a matter of professional courtesy, employment remains at-will and no notice is legally required.

| Role Level                                            | Requested Notice Period |
|-------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------|
| Individual Contributor (Bands 1-3)                    | 2 weeks                 |
| Senior Individual Contributor / Team Lead (Bands 4-5) | 3 weeks                 |
| Manager / Senior Manager (Bands 6-7)                  | 4 weeks                 |
| Director and Above (Bands 8+)                         | 6 weeks                 |

Nexarion reserves the right to accept a resignation immediately and place the employee on garden leave (paid through the notice period but not required to work) at its sole discretion, particularly where the employee has access to sensitive client or competitive information.

### 13.2 Offboarding Checklist

All separating employees must complete the following offboarding steps prior to their last day. Failure to complete any item may delay the issuance of the final paycheck or continuation documentation to the extent permitted by law.

- Schedule and complete an Exit Interview with HR (voluntary, but strongly encouraged).
- Return all Company equipment (laptop, badge, access cards, mobile devices, keys).
- Confirm the transfer or archiving of work product, files, and client documentation per IT protocols.
- Provide a forwarding address for W-2 and correspondence.
- Complete COBRA election notice review with Benefits team.
- Confirm 401(k) options (rollover, leave in plan, or distribution) with Fidelity.
- Return any outstanding Company credit card and submit final expense reports.

### 13.3 COBRA Continuation Coverage

Upon separation, employees who were enrolled in Nexarion's group health, dental, or vision plans will receive a COBRA election notice from our COBRA administrator (WEX Health) within 14 days. Employees have 60 days from the notice date (or the coverage loss date, whichever is later) to elect COBRA. COBRA premiums are the full cost of coverage plus a 2% administrative fee. Coverage may continue for up to 18 months (36 months for qualifying disability or second qualifying event).

## Section 14: Acknowledgment of Receipt

This page should be signed, dated, and returned to your HR Business Partner within five (5) business days of your start date. A digital copy will be placed in your employment file in Workday.

*I, the undersigned, acknowledge that I have received, read, and understood the Nexarion Solutions, Inc. Employee Handbook (Version 4.2, effective January 1, 2025). I understand that this Handbook is not a contract of employment and does not alter the at-will nature of my employment. I understand that Nexarion Solutions reserves the right to amend, revise, or rescind any policy contained herein at any time, with or without notice. I agree to comply with the policies and standards set forth in this Handbook and understand that violation of these policies may result in disciplinary action up to and including termination of employment. I further acknowledge that I am responsible for staying informed of any updates to Company policy, which will be communicated via the HR portal and/or email.*

Employee Full Name (Print):

Employee ID:

Employee Signature:

Date:

Department / Team:

Manager Name:

HR Representative Signature:

Date Received by HR:

For questions regarding this Handbook or any HR policy, please contact the People Operations team:

|                            |                                           |
|----------------------------|-------------------------------------------|
| <b>HR Helpdesk:</b>        | hr@nexarionsolutions.com                  |
| <b>HR Main Line:</b>       | (404) 555-0192                            |
| <b>Ethics Hotline:</b>     | 1-888-NEX-ETHX   nexarion.ethicspoint.com |
| <b>EAP (Lyra Health):</b>  | 1-800-NEX-HELP (available 24/7)           |
| <b>Benefits Inquiries:</b> | benefits@nexarionsolutions.com            |

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Nexarion Solutions, Inc. | 412 Meridian Parkway, Suite 800, Atlanta, GA 30308 | [nexarionsolutions.com](https://nexarionsolutions.com)

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